When I started using TDD, I largely stopped using debuggers. Having small, focused tests eliminates most of the need to walk through code in a step debugger. That said, it's sometimes nice to be able to stop a test in progress and peer inside the Ruby virtual machine to see what's going on.

Enter Pry.

Pry is technically a Ruby console—a souped-up replacement for irb, but with some add-on gems. It makes an excellent debugger. You can even coax it to reload code changes and rerun specs from inside Pry, which is as close as you can get in Ruby to programming inside a Smalltalk image.

Pry improves on irb in many ways. It offers much more powerful examination of live Ruby objects. It also has some niceties that makes it easier to enter code in the console.

Let's load Pry and a couple of extras by including them in the :development, :test group of the Gemfile:

```
gem "pry-rails"
gem "pry-byebug"
gem "pry-stack_explorer"
gem "pry-rescue"
```

The pry-rails gem allows Pry to replace irb as the console when you run rails console and adds a couple of handy commands that provide Rails info inside Pry. The other two gems both provide additional useful behavior: pry-byebug allows you to step through the code, and pry-stack_explorer allows you to go up and down the stack trace.

A quickish bundle install, and you're on your way.

Basic Pry Consoling

There's a lot of great stuff in Pry and I'm not going to cover it all. Full docs are available online.[6]

You've set Pry up as your Rails console, so you can access it with a simple rails console:

```
$ rails c
Loading development environment (Rails 5.1.3)
[1] pry(main)> 1 + 1
=> 2
[2] pry(main)> project = Project.new(name: "Project Runway")
```

6. https://github.com/pry/pry/wiki